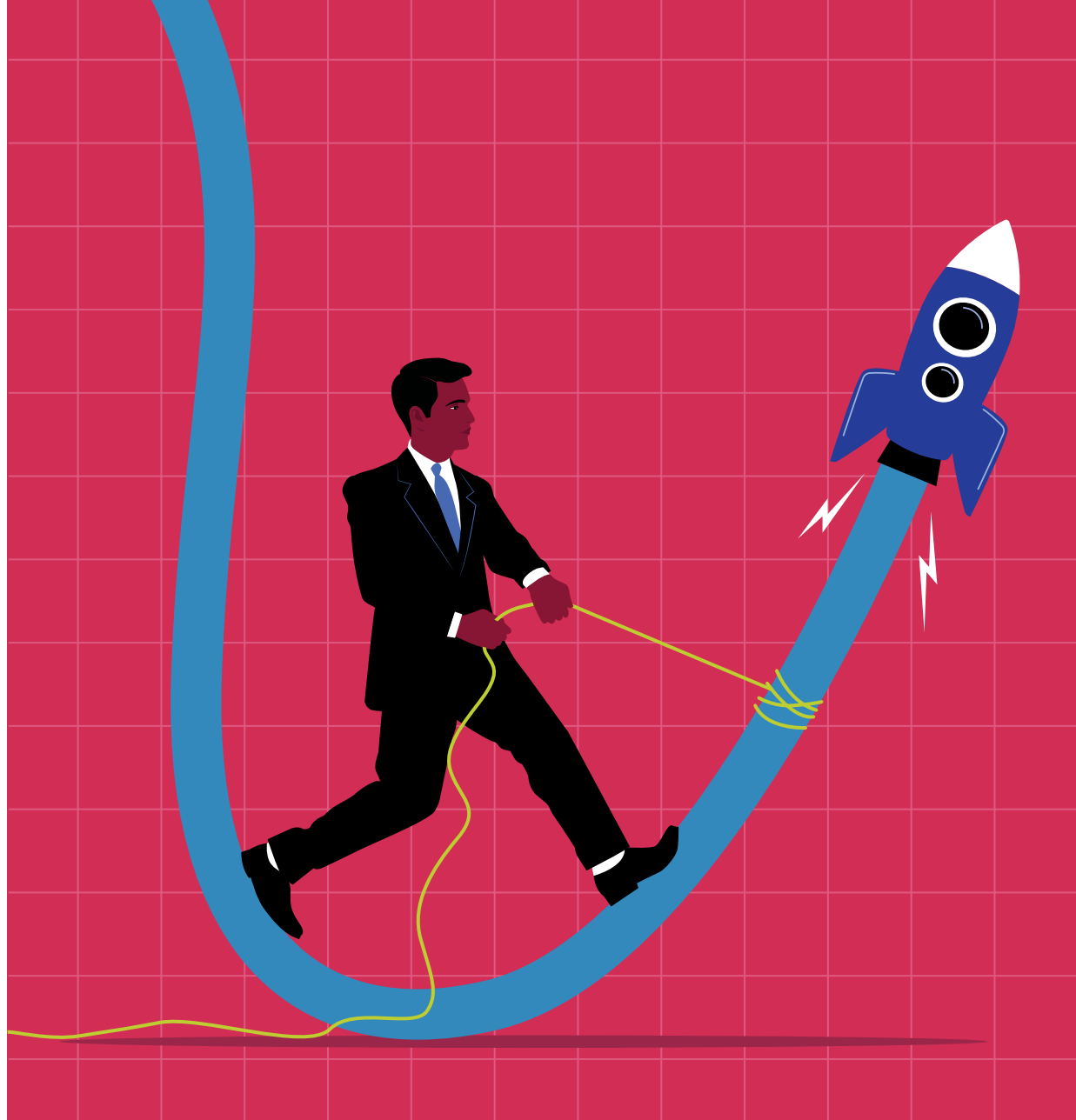




THE CASH GENERATORS

Amid the funding slowdown, a small set of start-ups stands out for a different reason. They are not burning cash. Instead, their core operations are generating cash, placing them in a far stronger position than many of their peers. In simple terms, their day-to-day business can sustain itself.

In an environment where investors have turned cautious and deals are taking longer to close, it provides a much-needed critical cushion. Avaada Energy, the Indian clean energy start-up, generated positive cash flow from operations of ₹1,661 crore—the highest among the country's most-funded start-ups. It is followed by Lenskart, which made its secondary market debut in November last year, and Walmart-

backed PhonePe, India's leading digital payments platform offering UPI transactions and a range of financial services.

The list of cash generators also includes logistics provider Delhivery, global hospitality platform OYO, food delivery giant Zomato, and the recently listed edtech platform PhysicsWallah.

Together, these companies highlight a different playbook where growth is balanced with operational discipline and cash generation.

CONCLUSION

The runway calculations reveal an uncomfortable truth: scale does not automatically translate into financial resilience. Several well-known start-ups, de-